successor to European colonialism. Consequently, scholars have directed their energies at understanding the coloniality of European colonialism as well as its successor, Western imperialism, both of which have been collectively referred to as Eurocentrism or Western-centrism or Western-normativism or 'North Atlantic abstract universal fictionalism'.[10]

The origins of Eurocentrism spawned by European colonialism and coloniality have been traced to what has been referred to as 'the Age of Discovery/Exploration' in the fifteenth century when Christopher Columbus set out in 1492 to 'discover' the 'New World', namely the non-Christian world.[11] Columbus' voyage marked the beginning of European colonisation and heralded a new chapter in European history, which led to the emergence of new conceptions of time, space and subjectivity that had tectonic implications for that continent and, most importantly, for 'others', that is, the rest of the world. In fact, the investigative spirit of 'The Renaissance', which is believed to have started in the fourteenth century, is credited to have laid the foundations for the Age of Discovery. The Age of Discovery significantly overlapped with The Renaissance, which was followed by 'The Reformation', leading to the Treaty of Westphalia in 1648, which was, in turn, followed by what is treated as the zenith of European civilisation—'The Age of Enlightenment/Reason' and 'The Industrial Revolution'.

The use of 'The' for each of these essentially European milestones by Europeans and the rest of the world is significant since it demonstrates the universalisation of European history as the history of humanity, in particular its 'modern' history. Specifically, the period between the fifteenth and nineteenth centuries is believed to have given birth to 'modernity' and several 'modern' concepts and ideas that are unconsciously accepted not only by Europe but also the rest of the world, including erstwhile colonised societies, which proudly, albeit unfortunately, base their contemporary discourse on such 'modern' ideas. These 'modern' ideas have significantly affected and altered conceptions of nature, universe, human agency, religion, race, language, political organisation of societies, the nature of State, its relationship with religion, conceptions of law and human rights, treatment of genders, science, notions of development and more across the globe. During the period of colonisation, European provincialism on each of these facets of life was introduced, rather imposed, and universalised in colonised societies, thereby replacing indigenous worldviews. Since all of